

The Hard Truth About the Kingdom

Matthew 25:14–30

God celebrates faithfulness.

“Well done, good and faithful servant. You have been faithful over a little; I will set you over much. Enter into the joy of your master.”

MATTHEW 25:14–30

Jesus told a story about a master, three servants, and a long absence — and it does not end the way we would write it. The parable of the talents is warm to the workers and unsparing to the fearful, and it asks a question most of us would rather not sit with: what did you do with what you were given? This lesson walks through each servant and lands on five hard truths about how the Kingdom actually works.

1 The Kingdom Comes First

MATTHEW 6:33

If you don't get the Kingdom right, you don't get Jesus right. The Kingdom wasn't a side topic for Jesus — it was His central message, the thread that tied all of His teaching together. That's why He said it must come first: "Seek first the Kingdom of God."

2 The Five-Talented Servant

FIVE TALENTS

When he received the five talents, he knew the expectation — a huge problem to solve, no experience, new things to learn. However he learned, the knowledge became a process, the process became a habit, and when it came time to take action, he did. God celebrates trust.

3 The Two-Talented Servant

TWO TALENTS

He could have complained — "Why did he get five and I only got two?" Instead, he put his talents to work. The Kingdom is not built on comparison. It is built on faithfulness with what you have been uniquely given.

4 The One-Talented Servant

ONE TALENT

The Bible tells us exactly what he was thinking: he was afraid. He buried the talent, protected it, and completely failed to use it. Fear stops the flow of faith — and it kept him from ever discovering what faith could have accomplished.

5 Five Hard Truths

THE RECKONING

Everyone has talent. Time is an opportunity — you're on the clock. Talent is meant to be used, not admired. Results matter, because accountability is real. And talents increase only when you use them.

GOLD NUGGETS

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